AI Bootcamp — Week 4: Coaching Readiness & Certification Gate

Tuesday — Student Exercise Guide

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OBJECTIVES

By end of Week 4, the candidate is cleared for Deep Learning Program (DLP) engagement — meaning they can:

- Deliver the player-coach model in a live pairing session with a Basic Prompting-level developer
- Recognize the difference between real adoption and polite compliance
- Handle the four most common resistance patterns (skeptic, over-truster, identity-protective senior, management blocker)
- Explain EDD, RTCC (WHO/WHAT/WHY/HOW), the load-bearing rule, and the Prompt/Harness/Model framework clearly to a developer who has never heard of any of them
- Produce artifacts that a client can use after the Embedded Engineer is gone
- Articulate the full DLP arc: two 6-week loops, 6 Trainer sessions landing at weeks 1/3/5/7/9/11, the introduce-then-reinforce cadence, the transfer model (workspace to real codebase), and the Stage 3 to Stage 4 trajectory
- Operate their half of the two-person delivery model: Trainer touchpoints, escalation rules, and the Week 12 joint rubric
- Pass the Certification Gate

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TIMING

- **Monday–Friday:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM with 1-hour lunch (7 hours each day)

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TUESDAY (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM): RESISTANCE SCENARIOS

Four scenarios, approximately 45–60 minutes each including debrief.

For each scenario: the Embedded Engineer candidate plays the Embedded Engineer role. A program manager or peer plays the developer or manager. Run the scenario, then debrief before moving to the next.

SCENARIO 1: THE SKEPTIC

Developer doesn't believe AI improves their workflow. Not hostile, just unpersuaded. They've tried it, got mediocre results, and moved on. They are willing to engage but are not going to change their behavior based on faith.

How do you get them to try something real without turning it into a debate? The EDD and RTCC disciplines are your tools here — a skeptic responds to evidence, not enthusiasm.

SCENARIO 2: THE OVER-TRUSTER

Developer ships AI output without review. They love it. They're moving fast. They're producing more than anyone else on the team. They're also accumulating invisible debt: tests that pass because they test what the AI generated, not what the requirement asked for; documentation that is fluent but wrong; code that compiles but has subtle logic errors the AI confidently introduced.

How do you slow them down without making them feel punished for enthusiasm? The EDD discipline — specifically the load-bearing test concept — is your lever here.

SCENARIO 3: THE IDENTITY-PROTECTIVE SENIOR

Senior engineer who has built their identity on deep technical knowledge. AI tools feel like a challenge to their value — as if the thing they spent years mastering can now be approximated by a tool anyone can use. They are not hostile. They are careful, thorough, and skeptical of shortcuts.

How do you engage them without triggering defensiveness? The key: EDD and RTCC are engineering disciplines. The senior engineer's instinct for rigor is exactly what makes them valuable here — if you can frame it correctly.

SCENARIO 4: THE MANAGEMENT BLOCKER

Manager is skeptical or actively interfering — "we don't have time for this right now" or "just teach them to use Copilot and move on." They are not hostile to AI in general; they are protecting their team's delivery commitments and they see the DLP as a distraction.

How do you navigate this without burning the relationship? The DLP's artifacts-over-advice and real-work-not-exercises design principles are directly relevant here — the Embedded Engineer is not running workshops, they are committing things to the codebase.

12:00 – 1:00 PM — LUNCH (BETWEEN SCENARIOS AS SCHEDULE ALLOWS)

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